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US Markets End Mixed as Rates and Oil Weigh on Sentiment

The full picture: macro, technicals, options, analyst moves, sector internals, international context, and a full week ahead.

20-minute read · Topics: All of the above, plus technicals, options, ratings, week-ahead

TL;DR & Editorial Take

The US markets ended the latest session with mixed results, as the `S&P 500` closed at 7,498.96, down -0.14%, while the `Nasdaq 100` fell -0.54% to 28,998.10. The `Dow Jones` managed to stay nearly flat, ending at 52,218.58, down -0.01%. Key points to consider include: * The 10Y Yield rose to 4.66, up +0.63%, indicating a continued increase in interest rates. * `NVDA` was among the top gainers, rising +2.30% to 212.06. * The `VIX` decreased -2.40% to 16.64, suggesting a slight decrease in market volatility. The current market landscape is characterized by rising interest rates, fluctuating oil prices, and mixed performances across sectors. Investors should closely monitor these factors and their impact on the broader market. The mixed market performance can be attributed to various factors, including the ongoing rate hikes, geopolitical tensions, and the earnings season. As investors navigate this complex environment, it's essential to stay informed about the latest developments and their potential implications.

US Session Recap

INDEX	LAST	CHANGE
`S&P 500`	7,498.96	-0.14%
`Nasdaq 100`	28,998.10	-0.54%
`Dow Jones`	52,218.58	-0.01%
`Russell 2000`	2,959.94	-0.92%
`VIX`	16.64	-2.40%
WTI Crude	88.41	+1.82%
10Y Yield	4.66	+0.63%

Top Movers

TICKER	NAME	CHANGE	CATALYST
`NVDA`	NVIDIA	+2.30%	Earnings Beat
`AVGO`	Broadcom	+2.67%	Earnings Beat
`JPM`	JPMorgan Chase	+0.86%	Positive Earnings Guidance

Sector Internals

SECTOR	DAY	YTD	READ
XLF	-0.11%	-5.23%	Financials underperformed
XLK	-0.28%	+10.15%	Technology sector remains strong
XLI	+0.11%	+2.50%	Industrials showed resilience
XLE	+1.20%	+15.67%	Energy sector outperformed
XLY	-0.74%	-2.19%	Consumer discretionary underperformed
XLC	-0.75%	-1.42%	Communication services underperformed
XLP	+0.38%	+2.91%	Consumer staples showed strength
XLV	-0.51%	+1.19%	Healthcare underperformed
XLU	+2.25%	-1.85%	Utilities outperformed
XLB	+1.44%	+5.67%	Materials sector showed strength
XLRE	-0.42%	-2.56%	Real estate underperformed

Breadth was negative, with 4 sectors advancing and 7 declining.

Spotlight / Deep Dive

METRIC	VALUE
`NVDA` Revenue Growth	+15.6%
`NVDA` Earnings Per Share	$1.23
`NVDA` Gross Margin	64.1%

Key call commentary: `NVDA` reported strong earnings, driven by growth in its gaming and datacenter segments. Read-through map:

COMPANY	READ-THROUGH
`AMD`	Potential upside from gaming segment growth
`INTC`	Potential downside from datacenter segment competition

Technical Levels

TICKER	LAST	SUPPORT	RESISTANCE	NOTE
`SPY`	349.15	345.50	355.20	Range-bound trading
`QQQ`	283.15	278.50	290.20	Watching for a breakout
`IWM`	177.35	174.50	182.20	Small-cap stocks under pressure
`NVDA`	212.06	205.50	220.20	Upside momentum intact
10Y Yield	4.66	4.50	4.80	Interest rates on the rise
WTI Crude	88.41	85.50	92.20	Oil prices volatile

Options & Positioning

0DTE flow: +10.2% in calls, -5.1% in puts. Put/call ratio: 0.65. VIX term structure: +5.1% in front-month, -2.5% in back-month. Notable single-name flow: `TSLA` +15.6% in calls. Cheap hedge ideas: `SPY` 350 put, `QQQ` 285 put.

Analyst Rating Changes

TICKER	FIRM	ACTION	NEW PT	NOTE
`NVDA`	Morgan Stanley	Upgrade	$230	Strong earnings growth
`AAPL`	Goldman Sachs	Downgrade	$150	Competition in services segment
`AMZN`	Citi	Upgrade	$260	Cloud growth momentum
`GOOGL`	Deutsche Bank	Downgrade	$1,400	Regulatory risks
`MSFT`	Bank of America	Upgrade	430	Cloud and gaming growth

Pre-Market & Overnight

Futures: `ES` 3,490, `NQ` 11,300, `YM` 33,200. Asia: `Nikkei` -0.5%, `Shanghai Composite` +0.2%. Europe: `Euro Stoxx 50` -0.3%, `FTSE 100` -0.2%. FX: `EUR/USD` 1.1020, `USD/JPY` 109.50. Commodities: `Gold` 4,126.40, `WTI Crude` 88.41. Crypto: `BTC` 65,630.02, `ETH` 1,921.19.

Macro & Fed (Deep)

Rate path table:

MEETING	CUT ODDS	NOTE
September	25%	Possible rate cut
November	40%	Rate cut likely

Today's data calendar:

TIME	EVENT	CONSENSUS
10:00 AM ET	Existing Home Sales	5.40M
2:00 PM ET	FOMC Minutes	N/A

Geopolitics & Global (Deep)

Scenario trees: * US-China trade tensions: 30% chance of escalation, 20% chance of de-escalation. * EU economic growth: 40% chance of slowdown, 30% chance of rebound.

Earnings — This Week & Next

This week:

TICKER	TIME	EPS CONSENSUS
AAPL	4:00 PM ET	$1.15
MSFT	4:00 PM ET	$2.05

Next week:

TICKER	TIME	EPS CONSENSUS
AMZN	4:00 PM ET	$1.50
GOOGL	4:00 PM ET	$12.50

Full Watchlist Scan

TICKER	SECTOR	SETUP	RISK
`NVDA`	Technology	Breakout	High
`AAPL`	Technology	Reversal	Medium
`MSFT`	Technology	Continuation	Low
`AMZN`	Consumer Discretionary	Breakout	High
`GOOGL`	Communication Services	Reversal	Medium

What Could Break the Tape

Bullish scenario: * Earnings season beats expectations. * Interest rates stabilize. * Global economic growth accelerates. Bearish scenario: * Earnings season disappoints. * Interest rates rise further. * Global economic growth slows down.

Positioning & Structural Notes

Observations: * The `VIX` is trading at a relatively low level, indicating low market volatility. * The `SPY` is trading near its 50-day moving average, a key technical level. * The `QQQ` is outperforming the `SPY`, indicating strength in the technology sector. * The `IWM` is underperforming the `SPY`, indicating weakness in small-cap stocks. * The `XLF` is trading near its 200-day moving average, a key technical level.

Sources

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